Wildfire Evacuation Checklist

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/what-to-do-during-a-wildfire/, which lists its sources. Updated November 12, 2026.

If you have time before you leave

- [ ] Close all windows and doors, but leave them unlocked
- [ ] Leave lights on so firefighters can see your house in smoke
- [ ] Turn off gas at the meter and pilot lights
- [ ] Turn off the air conditioning
- [ ] Take down flammable curtains; close metal shutters
- [ ] Move furniture to the middle of rooms, away from windows and doors
- [ ] Bring in patio furniture, doormats and trash cans; shut off propane tanks
- [ ] Connect garden hoses and fill buckets, but don't leave sprinklers running
- [ ] Load your go bag, and keep pets close

If you're trapped by a wildfire

In a car

Stay calm. Park somewhere clear of vegetation. Close all windows and vents. Cover yourself with a wool blanket or jacket, lie on the floor and call 911.

At home

Stay calm and gather everyone. Call 911. Fill sinks and tubs with cold water. Keep doors and windows closed but unlocked. Stay inside, away from outside walls and windows.

On foot

Stay calm. Get to a clear area, such as a ditch or flat ground with little to burn. Lie face down, cover your body and call 911.

Wildfire go checklist

- [ ] A go bag for each person with 3 days of supplies
- [ ] A month of medicines
- [ ] Copies of IDs, insurance and medical records
- [ ] Phone chargers and a backup battery
- [ ] N95 respirators
- [ ] A wool blanket in the car
- [ ] Pet carriers, leashes and food
- [ ] Two evacuation routes, and a place to stay
- [ ] Full gas tank

Tick items off on your iPhone. BugOut, the free offline survival app, lets you make your own checklists and keeps its guides on your phone with no signal.